

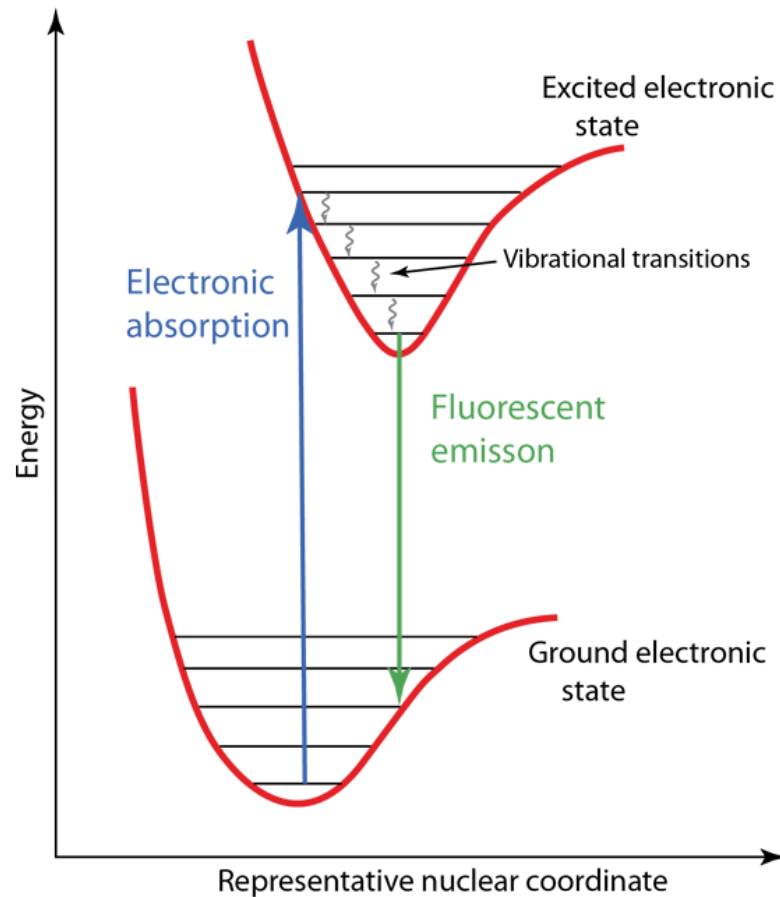
Bachelor QC II

Predicting UVvis absorption properties

Prof. Dr. Carolin Müller

April 21, 2026

Stationary absorption and emission properties



time-dependent Schrödinger equation

$$-\frac{\hbar}{i} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Psi = \hat{H} \Psi, \quad \text{with } \Psi_j = \exp \left(-\frac{i E_j t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_j \quad (1)$$

time-dependent Schrödinger equation

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$$\hat{H} = \hat{H}^0 + e_0 \mathbf{r} \sin(2\pi \nu t) \quad (2)$$

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Wavefunction evolves in the presence of the perturbation and may be expressed as the linear combination of the complete set of solutions to $\hat{H}$:

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Termination of the radiation field will cause the WF to collapse to a stationary state with probability $|c_k|^2$. Let's put things together: (3), (2) $\rightarrow$ (1)

$$-\frac{\hbar}{i} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \sum_k c_k \exp \left(-\frac{i E_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k = \left[\hat{H}^0 + e_0 \mathbf{r} \sin(2\pi \nu t) \right] \sum_k c_k \exp \left(-\frac{i E_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k \quad (4)$$

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$$\begin{aligned} & -\frac{\hbar}{i} \sum_k \frac{\partial c_k}{\partial t} \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k + \sum_k c_k E_k \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k = \\ & \sum_k c_k E_k \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k + e_0 \mathbf{r} \sin(2\pi\nu t) \sum_k c_k \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k \end{aligned}$$

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The change of c_k with time is dependent of the perturbing radiation field.

$$-\frac{\hbar}{i} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \sum_k c_k \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k = \left[\hat{H}^0 + e_0 \mathbf{r} \sin(2\pi\nu t) \right] \sum_k c_k \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \phi_k \quad (5)$$

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$\langle \phi_m | \rightarrow (6)$, and integration

$$-\frac{\hbar}{i} \sum_k \frac{\partial c_k}{\partial t} \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \delta_{mk} = e_0 \sin(2\pi\nu t) \sum_k c_k \exp \left(-\frac{iE_k t}{\hbar} \right) \langle \phi_m | \mathbf{r} | \phi_k \rangle \quad (7)$$

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Assume a small perturbation, so we can use coefficients for the ground state ϕ_0 :

$$\frac{\partial c_m}{\partial t} = -\frac{i}{\hbar} e_0 \sin(2\pi\nu t) \exp\left[-\frac{i(E_m - E_0)t}{\hbar}\right] \langle \phi_m | \mathbf{r} | \phi_0 \rangle \quad (9)$$

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Integration of (9) over time gives:

$$c(\tau) = \frac{1}{2i\hbar} e_0 \left[\frac{\exp(i(\omega_{m0} + \omega)\tau) - 1}{\omega_{m0} + \omega} - \frac{\exp(i(\omega_{m0} - \omega)\tau) - 1}{\omega_{m0} - \omega} \right] \langle \phi_m | \mathbf{r} | \phi_0 \rangle$$

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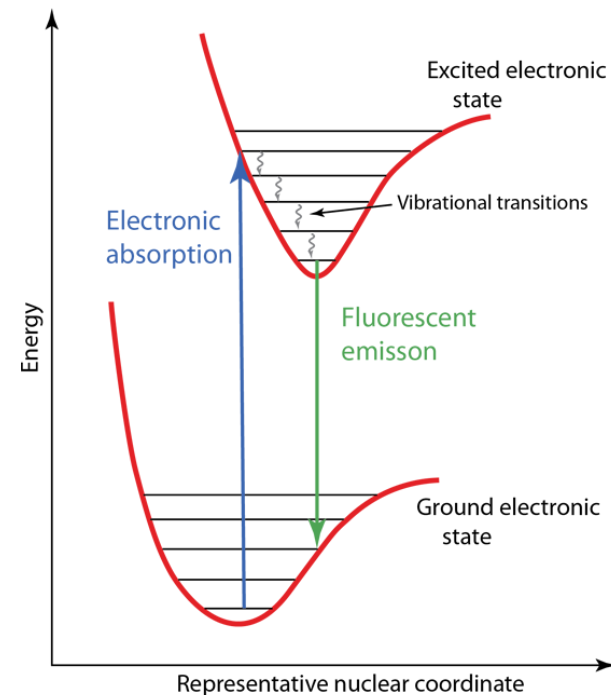
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Qualitative points:

- $\langle \phi_m | \mathbf{r} | \phi_0 \rangle$:
- $\omega_{m0} - \omega$ in the denominator:



Time-dependent Density Functional Theory

Similar formalism as time-dependent perturbation theory.

→ poles of polarizability matrix determine vertical excitation energies:

$$\langle \alpha \rangle_{\omega} = \sum_{m>0} \left[\frac{|\langle \phi_m | \mathbf{r} | \phi_0 \rangle|^2}{\omega_{m0} + \omega} - \frac{|\langle \phi_m | \mathbf{r} | \phi_0 \rangle|^2}{\omega_{m0} - \omega} \right]$$

- sensitive to functional
- problematic with charge transfer transitions

Computation of absorption properties

TDDFT in Orca 6

orca6 input

```
1 !B3LYP def2TZVP # FUNCTIONAL BASIS
2 %TDDFT
3   NR00TS 20 # number of states
4 END
5 * XYZFILE 0 1 td_E-AB_acn.xyz # CHARGE MULTIPLICITY COORDINATES
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----- TD-DFT EXCITED STATES (SINGLETs) -----

the weight of the individual excitations are printed if larger than 1.0e-02

```
STATE 1: E= 0.094004 au      2.558 eV      20631.4 cm**-1 <S**2> = 0.000000 Mult 1
         46a -> 48a : 0.988678
         46a -> 52a : 0.010160

STATE 2: E= 0.128128 au      3.487 eV      28120.8 cm**-1 <S**2> = 0.000000 Mult 1
         47a -> 48a : 0.986873
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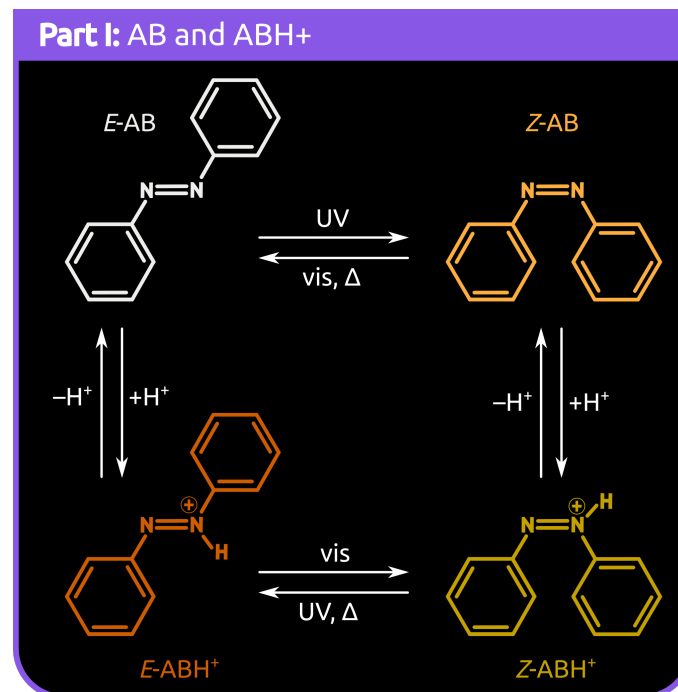
----- ABSORPTION SPECTRUM VIA TRANSITION ELECTRIC DIPOLE MOMENTS -----

Transition	Energy (eV)	Energy (cm ⁻¹)	Wavelength (nm)	fosc(D2)	D2 (au**2)	DX (au)	DY (au)	DZ (au)
0-1A -> 1-1A	2.557971	20631.4	484.7	0.0000000000	0.000000	-0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
0-1A -> 2-1A	3.486530	28120.8	355.6	0.899300393	10.52818	-3.24007	0.17362	-0.000000

Computation of absorption data

pH dependent absorption spectra of azobenzenes

- Calculate absorption properties of E/Z-azobenzene derivatives
 - Excitation energies
 - Oscillator strengths
 - Character of states
- visualization and discussion of results
 - plot charge density differences
 - compare absorption properties of E/Z-isomers
 - compare absorption properties at different protonation stages

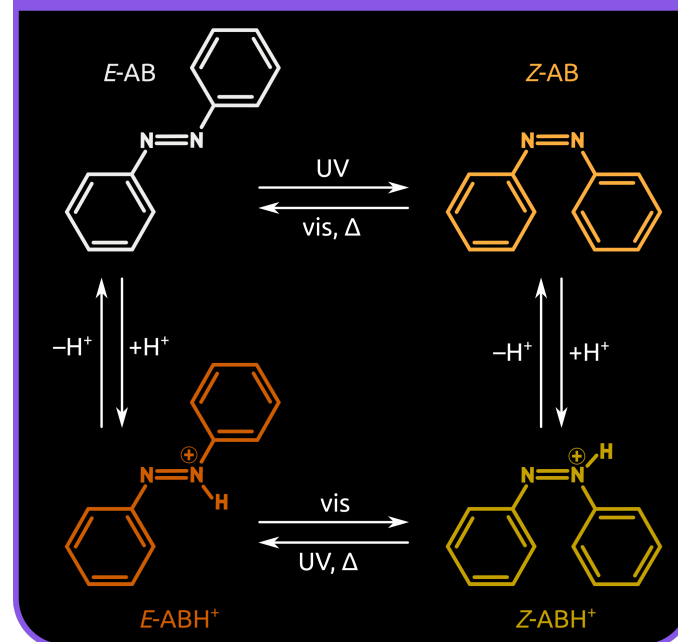


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Part I: AB and ABH⁺



Instructions and sample inputs, coordinates etc.:

<https://github.com/CompPhotoChem/bachelor-qc-2/tree/main/azobenzene>